

Subject Description Form

Subject Code	SFT413FB
Subject Title	Fashion Brand Management
Credit Value	3
Level	4
Pre-requisite/ Co-requisite/ Exclusion	Pre-requisite: SFT326FB Fashion Consumer Behaviour Exclusion: ITC4058R Fashion Brand Management
Objectives	The subject gives an overview of the fundamental principles of fashion brand management (mgmt.) principles. It will develop students' skills in (i) analyzing the strategic contexts and capabilities of a fashion brand (e.g., how a fashion brand is currently perceived in the market), (ii) defining strategic goals for the brand (e.g., planning how the brand should be perceived if it is to achieve its strategic mission/objectives), and (iii) developing strategic choices that can secure the set objectives of the brand.
Intended Learning Outcomes	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: (a) appreciate the vital role that the fashion industry plays in the global economy, society, and the environment (b) identify and analyze a fashion brand's strategic context, including important fashion industry trends and fashion business models, that will influence the industry in the future (c) define the brand's strategic capability such as its resources and strategic competences (d) analyze the brand's TOWS, which is an extension of the classic SWOT analysis, to bring together the external and internal perspectives (e) develop strategic choices that can confer sustainable competitive advantage to the brand in the contemporary fashion industry (f) demonstrate innovative problem-solving skills and analytic thinking abilities and nurture professionalism, communication skills, and team spirit.

**Subject Synopsis/
Indicative Syllabus**

(I) Strategic approach to fashion brand mgmt.

- The overview of the global fashion industry
: appreciate its economic, social, and cultural importance
- The characteristics and dimensions of the fashion industry
: with respect to organizational players and market levels
- The structural and technological changes
: which have shaped the contemporary fashion business
- Contemporary industry trends and business models
: which will affect the evolution of the industry

(II) Strategic thinking and planning for fashion brand mgmt.

- The fashion industry's unique context for strategic thinking and planning
- The definitions of strategy and strategic mgmt.
- The 3Cs approach to strategic analysis and mgmt.
 - (i) Context: the layers of strategic context
 - (ii) Capability: the meanings/types of strategic capability
 - (ii) Choice: the importance of strategic choice

(III) Strategic brand management process

- How to enhance brand knowledge
- How to identify and establish brand positioning
- How to build, measure, and manage CBBE
 - (i) Identify and develop new brand plans
 - (ii) Design innovative marketing programs
 - (iii) Measure/interpret brand performance
 - (iv) Grow and sustain brand equity

(IV) Fashion brand planning system

- Key steps of brand building suggested in the brand resonance model:
 - (i) Brand identity: ensure identification of the brand and its association in customers' minds with a specific product category, product benefit, and/or customer need
 - (ii) Brand meaning: establish the totality of brand meaning in customers' mind by strategically linking a host of the brand's tangible/intangible associations
 - (iii) Brand response: elicit the proper/favorable customer responses to the brand
 - (iv) Brand relationships: Convert brand responses to create an intense, active loyalty relationship between customers and the brand

Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus	(IV) A comprehensive fashion brand audit – Apply the acquired theories and concepts into developing student groups’ own fashion brand audit report (i) Choose a fashion brand that has encountered strategic drift (ii) Identify and analyze the brand’s strategic contexts and capabilities (iii) Develop strategic choices for the brand to sustain/grow brand equity
Teaching/Learning Methodology	<i>Lectures</i> will provide fundamental knowledge of fashion brand mgmt. such as the necessary concepts and theories. <i>Tutorials</i> will be used to introduce up-to-date trends of fashion industry trends and business models, and to walk students through the group or individual project/assignment development. <i>Quizzes</i> will be employed to help students gauge their understanding of the subject topics and concepts. <i>Group/individual projects</i> will be given to develop students’ ability to analyze the strategic contexts and capabilities of fashion brands and propose innovative and relevant mgmt. strategies for the brands. <i>In-class participation</i> will be very important in tutorials and group projects which are based on group discussion. With proper Honour Declaration and clear elaboration on the level of GenAI usage, students may adopt AI-assisted idea generation and structuring and AI-assisted editing in their submitted work. However, their original work with no AI content must be provided in an appendix.

Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes	Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weight ing	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)					
			a	b	c	d	e	f
	Continuous Assessment	50%						
	1. Group project	25%	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	2. Individual assignment and participation	15%	✓	✓	✓	✓		
	3. Quizzes	10%	✓					
	Examination	50%	✓	✓	✓	✓		
	Total	100%						
Explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes: The assessment methods will be designed to assess diverse aspects of students’ the learning outcomes.								
Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:							
	• Lecture					26 Hrs.		
	• Tutorial					12 Hrs.		
	Other student study effort:							
	• Group project					67 Hrs.		
	Total student study effort					105 Hrs.		

Reading List and References	<u>Books</u> Varley, R., Roncha, A., Radclyffe-Thomas, N., & Gee, L. (2018). <i>Fashion management: A strategic approach</i>. Macmillan International Higher Education. Keller, K. L., & Swaminathan, V. (2020). <i>Strategic brand management: Building, measuring, and managing brand equity</i>. Harlow: Pearson. <u>Periodicals</u> The Boston Consulting Group McKinsey & Company Harvard Business Review <u>Newspapers</u> Forbes New York Times
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